

ometrya4paper, margin=1in
 \headFate's Edge
 wtcolorboxnpcbox[1] colback=gray!5, colframe=gray!50, fonttitle=, title=1, boxrule=0.5pt
 wtcolorboxlocationbox[1] colback=blue!5, colframe=blue!50, fonttitle=, title=1, boxrule=0.5pt
 wtcolorboxmechanicsbox[1] colback=green!5, colframe=green!50, fonttitle=, title=1, boxrule=0.5pt

LARGE The Mist Walker

Mistlands Bells, Salt, and Breath

A Fate's Edge Adventure for Seasoned (Tier II) Characters

ADVENTURE OVERVIEW

@ll Title: The Mist Walker
Region: Mistlands Bells, Salt, and Breath
Theme: Supernatural horror, thresholds between worlds, corruption of sacred wards
Level: Seasoned (Tier II)
Length: 34 Sessions

PREMISE

A powerful entity from the Ways Between is using the Mistlands as a conduit to enter the mortal world, corrupting the belllines and threatening to break the barriers between realms. The players must investigate the growing supernatural disturbances, uncover the source of the corruption, and either stop the entity or find a way to send it back where it came from.

HOOK

The adventure begins when the players encounter one of the following scenarios:

tem A ferryman refuses to take them across a normally safe waterway, claiming "the mist walks where it shouldn't" and that bells have been heard tolling underwater. tem A BellWarden approaches them in a tavern, desperate for help as belltowers across the region are ringing without being touched, and some bells are ringing notes that don't exist. tem Their patron sends them with a letter that should have arrived three days ago, but the courier claims they delivered it yet the recipient has no knowledge of receiving it.

KEY NPCs

BellWarden Maren Thorne **Role:** Dedicated keeper of the belllines
Skills: Lore 3, Notice 2, Command 2
Knowledge: Bellline mechanics, history of Mistlands wards
Complication: Increasingly rattled by corruption, may make poor decisions under stress
Position: Desperate (when discussing corruption), Controlled (normal interaction)

Ferryman Eddis Crow **Role:** River guide with supernatural awareness
Skills: Survival 3, Notice 3, Skirmish 1
Knowledge: Waterway currents, mist phenomena
Complication: Seeing things that aren't there, becoming unreliable

Position: Controlled (normal), may shift to Desperate if pressured about origins

Pall WatchTower **Description:** Elevated observation post above the mist
Supernatural Features:

tem Reflections move independently (Notice vs DV 3 to detect) tem Temporal echoes of past events tem Watchers may vanish or become echoes themselves

Challenges:

tem Climbing while disoriented (Athletics vs DV 4) tem Distinguishing real from echo observations (Insight vs DV 4) tem Avoiding temporal displacement effects

GhostFerry Slip **Description:** Dock with temporal anomalies

Anomalies:

tem Ferries arrive before departure tem Passengers gain false memories tem Objects phase in and out of existence

Navigation Challenge:

tem Timing ferry departure (Wits + Survival vs DV 4) tem Identifying real vs. temporal echo passengers tem Avoiding memory contamination effects

Weeping Gate **Description:** Western palisade with iron tear bells

Primary Anchor Point:

tem Bells weep actual iron tears tem Strongest concentration of Mist Walker's influence tem Physical barriers becoming permeable

Final Confrontation Features:

tem Multiple approach vectors tem Environmental hazards from bell resonance tem Possessed Bell Wardens as opponents tem Sanctification ritual area

large **PLOT STRUCTURE**

Session 1: Signs of Disturbance

tem **Opening Scene:** Players encounter one of the hook scenarios. Establish the supernatural nature of the threat through minor but unsettling phenomena. tem **Key Objectives:** tem Interview Maren Thorne or Ferryman Eddis Crow tem Investigate disturbed belltowers (BellLine Levee) tem Experience first supernatural phenomena tem Discover evidence of interrealm movement

tem **Sample Encounters:**

tem **False Bell Warning:** Players must navigate levee path while bells ring false warnings. (Athletics + Notice vs DV 4, Controlled/Standard) tem **Possessed Tower Keeper:** NPC behaves normally but gives subtly wrong information.

(Insight vs DV 4, Controlled/Limited) tem **Temporal Echo:** At GhostFerry Slip, players see themselves performing different actions. (Wits + Notice vs DV 3, Desperate/Limited)

tem **Session End:** Players discover the corruption is supernatural and originates from the Ways Between. Advance Mist Corruption Timer +2.

Session 2: Into the Mist

tem **Opening Scene:** Players venture deeper into affected areas. Supernatural phenomena intensify. tem **Key Objectives:**tem Navigate through corrupted bellline territory tem Confront direct manifestations of Mist Walker's influence tem Discover the entity's anchoring strategy tem Make moral choices about possessed NPCs

tem **Sample Encounters:**

tem **Pall WatchTower Investigation:** Players must distinguish real observations from temporal echoes. (Insight + Lore vs DV 5, Desperate/Standard) tem **Possessed Ferry Passenger:** NPC attempts to lead ferry into dangerous mist. (Command + Skirmish vs DV 4, Controlled/Great) tem **Bell Correlation Puzzle:** Decode corrupted bell patterns to find safe path. (Lore + Wits vs DV 5, Controlled/Standard)

tem **Session End:** Players identify Weeping Gate as primary anchor point. Advance Mist Corruption Timer +2.

Session 3: The Weeping Gate

tem **Opening Scene:** Players approach the primary anchor point. Full supernatural manifestation. tem **Key Objectives:**tem Deal with complete supernatural corruption tem Confront the Mist Walker directly or through proxies tem Execute chosen resolution strategy tem Resolve immediate threat to Mistlands

tem **Sample Encounters:**

tem **BellWarden Possession Wave:** Multiple NPCs turn hostile simultaneously. (Combat encounter, Desperate position for players) tem **Sanctification Ritual:** Complex ritual to purify anchor point. (Extended challenge, Craft + Arcana vs DV 6) tem **Mist Walker Confrontation:** Direct encounter with entity. (Variable based on player approach)

tem **Session End:** Resolution of main conflict. Advance or reduce Mist Corruption Timer based on outcome.

KEY MECHANICS

Mist Corruption Timer [8]

tem **Advance +1:** Belllines fail to function properly tem **Advance +1:** NPCs become possessed or influenced tem **Advance +2:** Players fail to properly sanctify corrupted areas tem **Advance +1:** The Mist Walker successfully tempts a PC with forbidden knowledge tem **Advance +2:** Direct confrontation with entity results in player retreat tem **When Full:** Barriers between realms begin to collapse, permanent supernatural changes to region

BellLine Functionality

tem **Normal:** +1 Position for travelers, clear warnings tem **Partially Corrupted:** Controlled position, misleading warnings (DV 4 to navigate) tem **Fully Corrupted:** Desperate position, attracting rather than warning (DV 5+ to navigate) tem **Restored:** Return to normal function, may grant +1 Boon for safe passage

Possession and Influence

tem **Detection:** Insight + Notice vs DV 4 to identify possessed NPC tem **Resistance:** Spirit + Resolve vs DV 3 to resist temptation tem **Temporary Boost:** Possessed characters gain +1 die to one skill for scene, but generate 1 SB tem **Permanent Corruption:** If not cleansed, mark 1 segment on personal Corruption Timer tem **Cleansing:** Lore + Arcana vs DV 5, requires sanctified iron and salt

POSSIBLE RESOLUTIONS

Banishment

tem **Requirements:**tem Sanctify all 4 major corrupted belltowers (Extended challenge, each DV 5) tem Gather 3 bells that still ring true (Investigation challenge, DV 4 each) tem Perform willing sacrifice (Social/Command challenge, DV 5)

tem **Procedure:** Combined ritual requiring all party members tem **Costs:** 2 segments marked on each participant's Corruption Timer tem **Outcome:** Mist Walker banished, belllines restored, but some supernatural knowledge lost

Negotiation

tem **Discovery:** Entity was drawn by ancient barrier damage from 200 years ago tem **Options:**tem Help repair original damage (Extended Craft/Arcana challenge, DV 6) tem Offer different anchoring point (Investigation/Survival challenge, DV 5) tem Trade knowledge for departure (Lore vs DV 4, but mark Corruption)

tem **Costs:** Ongoing obligation to monitor new anchor point, 1 segment Corruption per party member tem **Outcome:** Entity departs but may return with new demands, players gain some forbidden knowledge

Containment

tem **Approach:** Strengthen existing wards rather than eliminate entity tem **Requirements:**tem Establish new protective measures (Craft + Arcana, DV 5) tem Create monitoring protocol (Command + Lore, DV 4) tem Accept entity's continued presence (Mark ongoing Complication)

tem **Costs:** Ongoing responsibility, periodic Corruption exposure tem **Outcome:** Entity contained but players become wardens, gain access to some supernatural knowledge

REWARDS AND CONSEQUENCES

Immediate Rewards

tem WardSalt allotment (2 uses): +1 Position when navigating mist tem BellKey to one tower: Access to restricted bellline areas tem Lantern Writ: Safe passage through mist for one journey tem WraithIndemnity: Protection from supernatural legal consequences

Longterm Consequences

tem **Banishment:** Region returns to normal, but players lose access to supernatural insights tem **Negotiation:** Entity may return with new demands, players gain 1 segment permanent Corruption tem **Containment:** Players become responsible wardens, gain 1 follower (BellWarden apprentice) tem **Personal Effects:** Individual corruption or enlightenment based on choices made

GM NOTES

Pacing

Maintain tension by gradually increasing supernatural elements:

tem Session 1: Minor disturbances, unsettling but manageable tem Session 2: Direct supernatural encounters, clear otherworldly threat tem Session 3: Full manifestation, existential threat to region

Player Agency

Provide multiple paths to resolution:

tem Combat approach: Direct confrontation with possessed NPCs and entity tem Investigation approach: Decoding supernatural phenomena to find weaknesses tem Social approach: Negotiating with entity or managing possessed NPCs tem Ritual approach: Complex sanctification and restoration procedures

Atmosphere

Emphasize isolation and otherworldly nature:

tem Use fog, bells, and shifting paths to create unsettling atmosphere tem Sound effects: Distant bell tones, whispers in mist, temporal echoes tem Visual elements: Moving reflections, false memories, phasing objects tem Temporal distortion: Events that don't follow logical sequence

Story Beats

Use Mist Walker's influence to generate complications:

tem 1 SB: Minor temporal displacement, false memory fragment tem 2 SB: NPC becomes temporarily possessed, misleading information tem 3 SB: Environmental hazard from bell resonance, path becomes unreliable tem 4+ SB: Direct manifestation of Mist Walker's influence, major NPC possession

SessionSpecific Guidance

tem **Session 1 Focus:** Establish supernatural threat without overwhelming players. Use unsettling but manageable phenomena to build tension. tem **Session 2 Focus:** Escalate to direct supernatural encounters. Players should feel the threat is real and growing. tem **Session 3 Focus:** Climactic confrontation. All previous elements converge. Players' choices have clear, significant consequences.

Alternative Endings

If players fail to resolve the main conflict:

tem **Partial Success:** Reduce corruption but don't eliminate threat. Sets up sequel adventure. tem **Compromise:** Players become possessed but use influence to contain entity from within. tem **Pyrrhic Victory:** Banish entity but at great cost (major NPC death, permanent regional damage).

Scaling for Different Tiers

tem **Tier I (Rookie):** Reduce entity Cap to 3, simplify ritual requirements, provide more NPC assistance. tem **Tier III (Veteran):** Increase entity Cap to 5, add

secondary entities, complicate ritual with additional requirements. tem **Tier IV (Paragon)**: Add political complications, multiple simultaneous anchor points, entity gains patron backing.